

# Rui Couto

Lead UX Product Designer • DRI • Agentic AI & Enterprise Platforms

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## PROFILE

Lead UX Product Designer & DRI with 7+ years owning end-to-end UX for enterprise identity, authentication, and agentic AI at OutSystems. I work where technical architecture, product strategy, and human behaviour converge, and defining the vision for emerging spaces before the patterns exist. Recognised as top 1% contributor in R&D; award-winning in internal hackathons.

## EXPERIENCE

**Lead UX Product Designer** • OutSystems • Mar 2020 - Present • Remote

- DRI and design lead across two value streams: Identity (AuthN, AuthZ, governance) and Agentic Lifecycle Management (ALM). 7+ years of sustained domain ownership, building the Identity UX area from zero, growing a team, and operating as the single continuity thread across multiple PMs and engineering teams.
- Co-pioneered the Agent Experience (AX) design practice at OutSystems; co-crafted the vision and interaction model for Agentic Lifecycle Management, defining supervisory UX patterns for autonomous agents before established patterns existed.
- Led end-to-end design for the Portfolios initiative: restructured the platform concepts hierarchy (introducing the concept of Portfolio which sits above pipelines, and below Organization), redesigned full product navigation, and traced structural changes across every screen and the IDE. Immediately adopted by the largest ODC customer at launch.
- Reversed an executive decision on Native IdP architecture by gathering customer evidence and quantifying ARR risk. Outcome reshaped the 2025 roadmap.
- Led UX for User Session Configuration (cross-value-stream, compliance-driven): 20 customers adopted within 2 days of launch, representing ~€3.06M combined ARR.
- Built and shipped an internal AI tool for content creation and review, an AI-driven feedback processing tool, and drove AI enablement sessions within the group democratised.
- Drove delivery roadmapping, data-informed prioritisation, vision setting, and cross-functional alignment with Product, Architecture, Engineering, and Research in several core projects.

**Senior Researcher** • HASLab / University of Minho • Jul 2017 - Mar 2020 • Braga

- Lead researcher in Interactive Systems and formal methods verification for safety-critical systems.
- Proposed and led scientific research projects; published in peer-reviewed venues.

**Invited Assistant Professor** • University of Minho • Sep 2014 - Mar 2020 • Braga

- Lectured software engineering courses at undergraduate and postgraduate level.

## EDUCATION

**PhD in Informatics** • University of Minho, Braga • 2012–2017

Focus: software engineering and pattern-based software development.

## CERTIFICATIONS

**Nielsen Norman Group (NN/g)**

Leading Highly-Effective UX Teams • New UX Managers

## AWARDS & RECOGNITION

**OutSystems Top Performer 2020** Top 1% contributor across R&D for Identity UX work.

**Open Days 2025** • "Pitch" Award Winner of internal hackathon for Agentic interaction with OutSystems product.

**Open Days 2024** • "Lab Rat" Award Winner of internal hackathon for AI-driven feedback tool.

## SKILLS

**Design & UX** End-to-end product design • Information architecture • Systems thinking • User research • Interaction design • Agentic/AI UX • Design systems

**Product** Roadmap planning • Vision setting • Stakeholder alignment • Data-informed decision making • Cross-functional DRI • OKR definition

**Tools** Figma • Miro • Jira • Productboard • Amplitude • Snowflake

**Technical** Software development (web, desktop, mobile) • Formal methods • API design familiarity • Identity protocols (AuthN/AuthZ, SSO, SAML, OAuth, OIDC)

**Languages** Portuguese (native) • English (professional)